Hint Cards

Cut along the dashed lines, fold each card on the dot-dash line so the hint is hidden, and open the next hint only when you are truly stuck. Always take Hint A before B, and B before C. Tip: cut without reading the hint halves.

Objective 1 · *Hint A*

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FOLD

OBJECTIVE 1 · HINT A

Reread how each suspect says they traveled on Thursday, in the interviews D4 to D8 and the statements in 02. Then find the one public schedule in the file that can test a travel claim.

Objective 1 · *Hint B*

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OBJECTIVE 1 · HINT B

On the bus timetable, D12, read the notes at the bottom, not only the times. One departure carries a letter. What does that letter mean, and did that condition apply on this Thursday?

Objective 1 · *Hint C*

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OBJECTIVE 1 · HINT C

Put the S note on D12 beside the second story in the newspaper clipping, D16. Then compare both with the bus time one suspect gives in their interview.

Objective 2 · *Hint A*

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OBJECTIVE 2 · HINT A

First find when the top rung was last known to be safe, and when Cornelius next climbed the ladder. The interviews D6 and D7 and the phone printout D18 give you both ends.

Objective 2 · *Hint B*

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OBJECTIVE 2 · HINT B

Now ask how anyone could reach the Rare Book Room while the shop was locked. PC Ashby's scene notes, D2, cover every door, the window and both doormats. The key register, D9, shows who holds keys.

Objective 2 · *Hint C*

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OBJECTIVE 2 · HINT C

Compare the back doormat in D2 with what Priya did at 5:30 pm (D6) and the time the rain began (D13). Then use D3 to see where Cornelius was after the shop closed, and who held a key set.

Hint Cards

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Objective 3 · *Hint A*

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OBJECTIVE 3 · HINT A

One item found under the ladder does not belong in a room that stayed locked. Reread the list in D2, then study that item's own exhibit. For the motive, look at the private note Cornelius left, D14.

Objective 3 · *Hint B*

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OBJECTIVE 3 · HINT B

D14 is written in shelf marks. Priya explains the pattern in D6, and the shelf list D15 gives every title. Count letters only, skipping spaces and punctuation. For the receipt, D17, match its trade account initials to a business named in 02.

Objective 3 · *Hint C*

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OBJECTIVE 3 · HINT C

Set the decoded note beside the September entries in the ledger (D10), Friday in the diary (D11) and the 3:12 pm message in D18. Then compare the receipt's time and where it was found with what its owner says in interview.

HOW TO USE HINTS

Hint A tells you which document to reread. Hint B points to the part of it that matters. Hint C names the things to compare side by side. No card gives you the answer: you still make the final step yourself.

PLAYING ON A SCREEN?

The same nine hints are built into Case-Checker.html. Press "Show Hint A," then B, then C, under each objective. The wording is identical to these cards.